

Key words:

Archetypal patterning
Organic organization
Wisdom
Health
Vital strength

Galdr:

uruz uruz uruz
uuuuuuuuuu
uuuuurrrrr
uuuuuuuuuu

Stadha:

Bend at the waist, with the back horizontal and parallel to the ground. Arms and fingertips point toward the ground; the head should be toward the east.



Magical workings:

1. Shaping and forming circumstances creatively through will and inspiration.
2. Healing and maintenance of good mental and physical health.
3. Bringer of fortunate circumstances.
4. Induction of magnetic earth streams.
5. Realization of causality.
6. Knowledge and understanding of the self.

3

Names: GMC *thurisaz*: the strong one,
giant
GO *thiuth*: the good one
OE *thorn*: thorn
ON *thurs*: giant

Alternate forms: þ Ƿ

Phonetic value: voiceless *th* as in "thorn"

Esoteric interpretation of name: Ása-Thórr, the enemy of unfriendly forces.

Ideographic interpretations: the hammer, or the thorn on a branch.



thurisaz thurisaz thurisaz
th th th th th th th th th th
thur thar thir ther thor
thu tha thi the tho
th th th th th th th th th th

Stadha:

Stand upright with the left arm bent at the elbow, hand on hip, with the palm grasping the hip bone. Face east or south.

**Magical workings:**

1. Defense (active).
2. Destruction of enemies, curses.
3. Awakening of the will to action.
4. Preparedness for generation in all realms.
5. Love magic.
6. Knowledge of the division and unity of all things.

4

Names: GMC *ansuz*: a god, ancestral god
 GO *ansus*: a runic god name
 OE *ós*: a god
 ON *áss*: a god, one of the AEsir

Alternate forms: 𐌺 𐌻 𐌿 𐌽

Phonetic values: *a* (*o* in the A-S row)

Esoteric interpretation of name: Ódhinn of the AEsir.

Ideographic interpretation: the wind-blown cloak of Ódhinn.

**COMMENTARY**

Ansuz is the *mysterium tremendum* of the rune row.

The A-rune is instrumental in the creation of mankind. It describes two of the several spiritual gifts given to Askr and Embla (the primal man and woman) by the gods Ódhinn, Hœnir, and Lódhurr (a threefold aspect of the god Ódhinn). These gifts were *önd* or *anda* (breath, spirit, animating life principle) and *ódhr* (inspired mental activity, inspiration). This is the stave of Ódhinn as the numinous god of magic and of ecstasy.

Ansuz is the receiver-container/transformer-expresser of spiritual power and numinous knowledge. This force is received from the AEsir and transformed in humanity to be reexpressed toward the multiverse in magical and religious acts. This ecology of power works in tandem with that described by Óðhinn's reception of rune wisdom and subsequent expression of that wisdom to mankind. The A-rune encompasses the medium through which numinous knowledge is received, the container of that power, and the force itself, which is manifested as the ecstatic state. This container-contained equation is common for symbols of the inspired or ecstatic state. In Norse mythology the poetic mead of inspiration and the vessel in which it is contained are both known by the name Óthrerir (the exciter of inspiration). This is the ecstasy that leads to the formation of a body of lore and wisdom.

This is the rune of the word, song, poetry, and magical incantation (*galdr*) as a container and expresser of magical force.

Ansuz is a magical ancestral power, one that has been handed down from generation to generation along genetic lines. The ancient Germanic peoples knew that they were "descended from their Gods," as the genealogies of their kings, heroes, and clanic chieftains show. The power link between gods and men was, for them, unbroken. It remains so. Through the power of this rune the realization of the link between the ancestral gods and their people may be regained. This is an ecstatic concept that complements the more stable, institutional force of *Othala*.

The A-rune embodies the death mysteries of the AEsir.

Key words:

Reception—transformation—
expression
Container/contained
Numinous knowledge
Inspiration
Ecstasy
Word-song
Death mysteries

Galdr:

ansuz ansuz ansuz
aaaaaaaa
aaaaaasssss
aaaaa
aaaaaaaaa

Stadha:

Stand upright. Stretch out both arms parallel, pointing them down slightly, with the left arm lower than the right. Face north or east.



Magical workings:

1. Increase of both active and passive magical powers and clairvoyant abilities, etc.
2. Convincing and magnetic speech, and the power of suggestion and hypnosis.
3. Acquisition of creative wisdom, inspiration, ecstasy, and divine communication.
4. Banishing of death and terror through knowledge of Ódhinn.

5

Names: GMC *raidho*: wagon
 GO *raidha*: wagon, ride
 OE *rádh*: a riding, way
 ON *reidh*: riding, chariot

Alternate forms:   

Phonetic value: *r*

Esoteric interpretation of name: the solar wagon, and the chariot of Thórr.

Ideographic interpretations: a wheel under the chariot  in the view:   as a half of the solar wheel (see the S-rune).

**COMMENTARY**

Raidho is the cosmic law of right and archetypal order in the multiverse. This is expressed by such natural phenomena as the daily path of the sun and the cycles of nature and humanity. The R-rune is the mystery of divine law, manifest in both the multiverse and in humanity.

Raidho came to be a symbol for organized religion, or better said, of *Ásatrú*, the ancient form of Germanic religion. In ancient times the external, self-conscious order of religion was much less *fixed* because of the internal, unconscious, and instinctual order of holiness. This internal order found expression in institutions that were a balanced blend of religion, magic, and law (politics). Today the R-rune is a symbol of the "way back to right," through the conscious efforts of *ásatrúarfólk* to recover the essence of the primal order.

This rune represents the right order of the initiate's journey through the paths of the Nine Worlds of Yggdrasill.

Good advice and judgment according to right are ascribed to *raidho*.

Another important aspect of the mystery of the R-rune is that of ritual; that is, arrangement of energy and actions according to a cosmic order for a specific purpose. Here the emphasis is on the right ordering of these energies.

Raidho is the channeling of force according to natural laws along the right road leading to the right result. It describes, and analyzes, a certain aspect necessary to the working of the laws of cause and effect (see also the P-rune).

The concept of rhythm and dance also are important to the R-rune. This rhythm is embodied in all the worlds of the multiverse. Through rhythmic action and ritual dance the vitki may perceive and blend with the personal rhythm, and in turn become one with the world rhythm and dance. This is the rune of that rhythmic ritual dance, which still should be practiced today.

Raidho also may be expressed in the concept of spiral development. This is in accordance with the traditional ideology of the cycles of existence, ever in circles but always rising (or sinking) toward a goal—the point. Reaching this goal is not an end but a transformation and new beginning for another outward expansion.

In popular tradition it is a symbol for the Vehmic Court, and as such it is a sign of the deep indigenous religious laws of the folk having precedence over those of the civil authority.

Key words:

Right action and order
Cosmic cyclical law
Religion—magic
Ritual
Rhythm
Journey

Galdr:

raidho raidho raidho
rrrrrrrrrr
ru ra ri re ro
rudh radh ridh redh rodh
(rut rat rit ret rot)
or er ir ar ur
rrrrrrrrrr

Stadha:

Stand straight, with the left arm bent at the elbow, palm on hip bone. The left leg should be slanted out, lifted off the ground; the right arm should be tightly at your side. Face south.



Magical workings:

1. Strengthens ritual abilities and experience.
2. Access to "inner advice."
3. Raises consciousness to right and natural processes.
4. Blending with personal and world rhythms.
5. Obtaining justice according to right.

6

Names: GMC *kenaz*: torch
 GO *kusma*: swelling
 OE *cén*: torch
 ON *kaun*: sore, boil

Alternate forms: 𐌗 𐌚 𐌛 𐌜 𐌝

Phonetic value: *k*

Esoteric interpretation of names: the controlled fire; cremation. The Gothic and Old Norse names are secondary—internal fire, inflammation, etc.

Ideographic interpretation: flame of the torch

**COMMENTARY**

The K-rune portrays the mystery of regeneration through death or sacrifice. This is the fire rune, that is, fire under human control in the form of the torch (as opposed to the more raw and archetypal power present in the F-rune).

Ritually, *kenaz* is the fire of creation, sacrifice, the hearth and the forge—fire controlled by mankind toward a willed result. Cremation as a funeral rite facilitates the transference of the psychic aspects of the psychosomatic complex to new and regenerated forms and prevents their return to the spent forms. The fire of the sacrifice cooks and makes the flesh of the sacrificial animal sacred and acceptable for consumption by men and gods. The fire is always viewed as a transforming and regenerating force.

Kenaz is the ability and the will to generate and create. Therefore, it is the rune of the artist and craftsman, and the technical aspects of magic. Again, the importance of controlled fire—controlled energy—is apparent. The controlled power of the psyche is combined with the

controlled energy of nature, and this results in a crafted object. This is the “human rune,” the rune of humankind.

A large amount of knowledge and technical lore is embodied in the K-rune, knowledge combined with ability.

The mystery of the creation of a third from the combination of two is also an aspect of *kenaz*. Opposites are bound together in an aesthetic fashion and the results of that union brought into manifestation.

The K-rune is the rune of human passion, lust, and sexual love—as *positive* attributes. This is the emotional root of creativity in all realms of action. The goddess Freyja finds many correspondences with this aspect of the rune.

Kenaz also is important to the concept *kin*, and especially to that part of clanic tradition that professes a unity of the living and dead members of the clan, existing in a syncretic form of conscious life force.

Key words:

Controlled energy
Ability
Transformation
Regeneration
Will to generate
Sexual lust
Creativity

Galdr:

kenaz kenaz kenaz
ku ka ki ke ko
kun kan kin ken kon
ok ek ik ak uk
kaunnnnnnnnn

Stadha:

Stand upright with the right arm raised at a 45° angle, while the left arm is lowered by the same amount. The palm of the right hand faces outward, drawing power, while the fingers of the left hand are pointed, projecting into manifestation.



Magical workings:

1. Strengthening of abilities in all realms.
2. Creative inspiration.
3. Higher polarization as a tool of operation.
4. Operations of regeneration, healing.
5. Love (especially sexual love).

7

Names: GMC *gebo*: gift, hospitality
 GO *giba*: gift
 OE *gyfu*: gift, generosity
 ON *gipt*: gift, wedding (not in
 younger row)



Alternate forms: ᚦ ᚧ ᚨ ᚫ

Phonetic value: g as in "gift"

Esoteric interpretation of name: that which is exchanged between gods and men.

Ideographic interpretation: the crossing of two beams in the buiding of a structure; interaction of two forces.

COMMENTARY

Gebo is the rune of "god," that is, the eminent unconscious magical force present in the Ginnungagap (magically charged void) before the formation of the Worlds.² The holy mystery of the two (or many) in one.

It is the giver, the giving, the given, and that which is given to; "the subject, verb, direct object and indirect object of the multiverse." This also describes a part of the mystery of sacrifice as the gift (ultimately of power) that is given to mankind by the gods in order to maintain the ecology of cosmic power.

By the power of this rune persons are bound together through an act of will in order to effect a result. This stave symbolizes the root force of runic orders, the retinue system, etc.

The G-rune has some functional similarities to the A-rune, since it is also a rune of ecstasy. It is the mystery of ecstatic magical power that is perceived and retained by the vitki as numinous knowledge.

Gebo contains the secrets of psychically joining two people (usually male/female), or several persons, in order that they may produce a creative power greater than their sum total. This is the rune of sex magic. Sex magic was practiced in ancient Germanic times, especially for the acquisition of numinous knowledge and wisdom. Sigurdhr, the greatest of Germanic heroes, was initiated

²In the old Germanic languages, before they were touched by Christian influence, the word "god" (ON *godh*) was neuter. After male-dominated Christian dogma was infused into the language, the gender of the word was changed to masculine.

into runic wisdom by the *valkyrja* called Sigdrífa (Brynhildr) in a ritualistic scene rich in sexual symbolism (a child is born from their union). This was the usual mode of sex magic in which energy was exchanged along the male/female polarity. Further evidence for this is provided by the eighteenth-rune stanza of the "Hávamál" (stanza 164):

That eighteenth I know,
which I never reveal
to maid or man's wife
anything is better,
than if one know it
this leads to the last of the songs—
but only for that one,
who embraces me
or that be my sister.

Gebo is the rune of the brotherly or sisterly lover, and it is the psychosexual force exchanged between two poles of power—human to human, or divine to divine. In the latter case, *gebo* describes the sexual life force used in fertility magic and that used in shamanistic practices.

Key words:

Magical force
Giver—giving—given—given to
Ecstasy
Sacrifice
Sex magic

Galdr:

gebo gebo gebo
gu ga gi ge go
gub gab gib geb gob
og eg ig ag ug
g a a a a f f f f f f f

Stadha:

Stand with legs spread, feet straight, and knees locked. Arms are stretched out in an angle forming an X, with hands directly over feet.



Magical Workings:

1. Sex magic.
2. Sex magical initiation.
3. Mystical union.
4. Increase in magical powers.
5. Harmony between brothers and sisters and lovers.
6. Magical influence in human and divine worlds.
7. Acquisition of wisdom.

8

Names: GMC *wunjo*: joy
 GO *winja*: pasture
 OE *wynn*: pleasure, delight
 ON *vend*: (a rune name) joy, hope
 (not in younger row)

Alternate forms:  

Phonetic value: *w*

Esoteric interpretation of name: relationship of beings descended from same source.

Ideographic interpretation: the clanic or tribal banner, or weather vane.



COMMENTARY

The W-rune is the root force of attraction that sympathetic beings (wights) have for one another, that is, wights descended from a common source. These beings are then bound together in an organic whole, which is exemplified in the world of men by the clan and tribe. In the ancient Germanic world, society was "clano-centric," for a strong traditional clan was the best protection against invaders from without or totalitarianism from within. By giving the honor and integrity of the clan first consideration the individual was best able to maintain his freedom.

Wunjo is the mystery of the harmonious existence of varied affiliated forces. In the clan this is the source of the highest human joy. When all members of the clan are harmoniously working together, while integrated into their environment in a syncretic manner, a true state of holiness exists.

The power of the W-rune aids in the promotion of fellowship and goodwill between brothers and sisters, as such is a powerful force in the maintenance of societies and guilds.

Wunjo is the energy that binds different fields of force together and is therefore an invaluable concept to rune magic. With this energy the vitki can bind several runes into a single harmonious force that can work toward a specific result.

Key words:

Harmony
Well-being
Fellowship
Binding

Galdr:

wunjo wunjo wunjo
wu wa wi we wo
wun wan win wen won
wo we wi wa wu
wwwuuuunnnnn

Stadha:

Stand upright with legs together. Place the fingertips of the left hand on the crown of the head. Keep the right arm close at the side.



Magical workings:

1. Strengthens links and bonds.
2. Invocation of fellowship and harmony.
3. Banishes alienation.
4. Happiness and well-being.
5. Realization of the links and multiplicity of relationships of all things.
6. Binding runes toward specific purposes (see bind runes, etc.).

9

NAMES: GMC *hagalaz*: hail, egg(?)
GO *hagl*: hail
OE *hægl*: hail
ON *hagall*: hail

Alternate forms: N H H H * +

Phonetic value: *h*

Esoteric interpretation of name: icy egg or seed of primal cosmic life and pattern.

Ideographic interpretations: the connection of two standing beams (realms of being) by a cross bar in half-timbered building technique (:H:) or the primal snowflake pattern (:* :).



COMMENTARY

Hagalaz is the cosmic ice egg that is filled with crystalized magical power and cosmic pattern. The hailstone is the symbol of the yeasty rime “egg” that contains the seed of Ymir, the primal rime-giant. Ymir was formed from the juncture of world fire of Muspellsheimr and world ice of Niflheimr. This is the complete potential multiversal paradigm—the egg of manifestation. This “seed” concept is emphasized in the Old Icelandic Rune Poem:

Hagall is a cold grain
and a shower of sleet
and a sickness of snakes

The H-rune is the mystery of the framework of the world, and defines the primal form of the multiverse. The snowflake forms itself along the sixfold pattern of the old holy sign :✠:, which came to replace :H: in the Younger Futhark.

Hagalaz is the complete model containing the potential energy of neutral power in the multiverse, which is born from the dynamic, generating, evolving unity of fire (energy) and ice (antimatter).

The H-rune describes the eternal cosmic harmony.

In Germanic religion and mythology the number nine is the most sacred and mysterious of numbers, there are nine worlds in Yggdrasill, Ódhinn hung for nine nights on that tree to gain the runes, the god Heimdalr was born of nine mothers, and so on. This is the number of a completeness that leads to a birth of greater power and productivity.

Hagalaz is the rune mother; this is because of its numerical value and its shape, :✠: (which may indeed be the primary one). All the runic forms may be derived from the sixfold *hagalaz* when it is placed within a solid figure (see Figure 2.2).

The H-rune embodies ongoing evolution within a fixed framework.

Hagalaz is a stave of protection and banishment because its complete and harmonious nature promotes special security and prevents the intrusion of disharmonious elements.

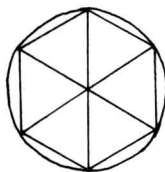


Figure 2.2. The mother rune: the solid *hagalaz*.

Key words:

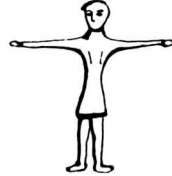
Cosmic pattern, framework
Completion
Union (cosmic egg)
Evolution (within framework)
Protection

Galdr:

hagalaz hagalah hagalah
h h h h h h h h h
hu ha hi he ho
hug hag hig heg hog
(hul hal hil hel hol)
oh eh ih ah uh
h h h h h h h h h

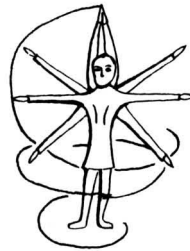
Stödhur:

I. Stand upright in a cross position with arms parallel to the ground and palms pointed outward.



II. This is a complete runic combination ritual of great power when properly performed.

1. Stand in cross position. Face north, take nine full inhalations, then turn with the sun (from north to east), and sing "hu ha hi he ho." Do this in all four directions, ending again in the north. This exercise may be performed from the east during daylight hours or at sunrise.



2. N-rune *stadha*: nu na ni ne no (on first turn) hu ha hi he ho (on second)

3. E-rune *stadha*: e e e e e e e e e (on first turn) hu ha hi he ho (on second)

4. I-rune *stadha*: i i i i i i i i i (on first turn) hu ha hi he ho (on second)

5. M-rune *stadha*: m m m m m m m m m (on first turn) hu ha hi he ho (on second)

6. T-rune *stadha*: Tiwaz Tiwaz Tiwaz (on first turn) hu ha hi he ho (on second)

7. G-rune *stadha*: gu ga gi ge go (on first turn) hu ha hi he ho (on second)

During the course of this exercise a total of 13 turns is made. Mentally take in no impressions during this operation; try to maintain an emptiness of consciousness. The exercise facilitates the workings of all the inner *hvel* (see section on *stadhagaldr*).

Magical workings:

1. Completeness and balance of power.
2. Mystical and numinous experience and knowledge.
3. Evolutionary, becoming operations.
4. Protection.

10

Names: GMC *naudhiz*: need, (fatalistic)
 compulsion
 GO *nauths*: necessity, need
 OE *nýd*: need, distress
 ON *naudh(r)*: distress, need, constraint



Alternate forms: 𐌺 𐌽

Phonetic value: *n*

Esoteric interpretation of name: need-fire and deliverance from distress.

Ideographic interpretation: the bore | and the bow \ that turns it to kindle the need-fire.

COMMENTARY

Naudhiz is the cosmic force used by the powers that form the “fates” of mankind and the world. For an analysis of the Germanic concept of “fate” (*φrlög*) and these “shaping powers” (Nornir), see the P-rune. The N-rune does not represent *φrlög*; rather it embodies a cosmic force necessary to its formulation, that of *resistance*. It is a synthesis of an implicit thesis and antithesis that is expressed throughout the rune row. *Naudhiz* is a two-pronged concept. It contains the idea of distress but also deliverance from that distress. This idea is well expressed in the pertinent stanza in the Old English Rune Poem:

(Need) constricts the heart,
 tho to the bairns of men it often becomes
 help and health nevertheless,
 if they heed it in time.

The N-rune is the self-created fire, the need-fire, created by friction/resistance to serve the needs of man in the material as well as spiritual realms. *Naudhiz* is the will-directed action, with knowledge and wisdom, which may act as a counterforce to the often negative powers of *þrlög*. The motto for this rune provided by Guido von List sums up this aspect of the N-rune quite neatly: "*Nütze dein Schicksal, widerstrebe ihm nicht!*" (*Use thy destiny, do not strive against it!*).

Naudhiz also represents the concept of stepping-forth-into-manifestation. This idea originated with the creation of the Nornir. At that time resistance was born in the universe, laws of causality went into action, and the seeds of the "destruction" of the world of the gods were sown. This must not be understood within the context of any type of "moral evil" or similar concepts. The holy Nornir also help sustain the multiverse by constantly pouring water from Urdhr's well onto the world-tree, so that it will not wither and die.

Because of the sexual elements inherent in the symbolism of this stave, the N-rune became a powerful tool in Icelandic love magic. Also, it is a strong rune of protection—especially spiritual protection.

Key words:

Resistance
Distress
Deliverance (need-fire)
Stepping-forth-into-
manifestation

Galdr:

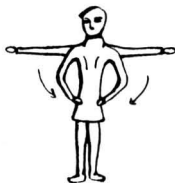
naudhiz naudhiz naudhiz
nnnnnnnnnn
nu na ni ne no
nudh nadh nidh nedh nodh
(nut nat nit net not)
un an in en on
nnnnnnnnnn

Stödhur:

1. Stand erect, with the right arm raised to the side and the left arm slanting down to form a line with the right.



2. a) Cross-stadha. Say "*æpandi nam.*"
b) After speaking the formula, lower your hands to your hips.



Magical workings:

1. Overcoming distress or negative *þrlög*.
2. Development of magical will.
3. Development of "spiritual" powers.
4. Use of the force of "resistance" under will toward magical goals.
5. Sudden inspiration.
6. Eliminates hate and strife.
7. Creates a need for order.
8. Recognition of personal need.
9. Protection.
10. Love magic—to obtain a lover.
11. Divination.

11

Names: GMC *isa*: ice

GO *eis*: ice

OE *is*: ice

ON *íss*: ice

Alternate forms: ı ı'

Phonetic value: *i* (pronounced *ee* as in "deed")

Esoteric meaning of name: primal matter/antimatter.

Ideographic interpretation: the icicle, or the primal ice stream/wave out of Niflheimr.



COMMENTARY

The I-rune is the antipolar force to the F-rune. *Isa* is a world-ice that flows forth from Niflheimr. It does not represent matter, but rather a concept of antimatter, which, when combined with the energy

flowing from Muspellsheimr, leads to the formation of what we call "matter" (Midhgardhr). *Isa* may be equated in some cases with the *prima materia* of other philosophies. In many ways this mystery may be symbolized by the "black hole." The I-rune is the force of attraction, gravity, inertia, entropy in the multiverse. In mythology, aspects of this force are represented by the rime-giants (*hrimthursar*). *Isa* is a stillness and lack of vibration—a unique mystery in the Germanic cosmogony/cosmology. This concept is as metaphysical as that which is called "spirit."

Ice and fire are the forces through which the world is created, but they are also the forces that will bring "existence" to an end.

Isa is a symbol for the individual ego because of its centralizing and concentrating effect. It is a force that holds the ego-self together during the stressful trials of the initiation process, and as such it is a bridge between the worlds and over waters.

Key words:

World ice
Antimatter
Concentration
Ego

Galdr:

isa isa isa
iiiiiiiiii
iiiiisssss
(sssss iiiii)
iiiiiiiiii

.....

Stödhur:

1. Stand erect with arms tight against sides.
2. Stand erect with arms straight overhead, with the palms touching one another.



.....

Magical workings:

1. Development of concentration and will.
2. Constriction, halting of unwanted dynamic forces.
3. Basic ego integration within a balanced multiversal system.
4. Power of control and constraint over other wights.

12

Names: GMC *jera*: the (good) year, harvest

GO *jér*: year

OE *gér*: year

ON *ár*: year, (good) season



Alternate forms: 𐌺 𐌽 𐌾 𐌿 𐌺 𐌽 𐌾 𐌿

Phonetic values: *j* (pronounced *y* as in “yard”). In the later ON period, after about 600 C.E., the initial *j* was lost in the West Norse dialects and thereafter the rune stood for *a*.

Esoteric interpretation of name: life cycle, cycle of the sun.

Ideographic interpretation: the holy marriage of heaven $\wedge$ and earth $\vee$, or the dynamic rotation of the summer-winter cycle.

COMMENTARY

Jera embodies the cyclical pattern of the universe expressed in the formula arising-being/becoming-passing-away to new arising. This is a basic pattern working throughout the rune row. The J-rune is one of the two “central runes” in the scheme of the Elder Futhark, and it defines the cyclical nature of the ever-becoming horizontal plane. It is the secret of the omnipresent circumference.

This is the mystery of the twelve-fold cycle of the yearly solar cycle. *Raidho* is the daily path and guiding force of the sun, *Jera* her yearly path, and *sowilo* the archetypal sun herself.

Jera is the reward for honorable, right, and lawful (natural) past action. This has no real moral implications—it is a natural law. If the sowing is done correctly, according to tradition, and “luck” (*hamingja*) is with you, then the reaping should be great. It is the fruition of efforts well spent toward a willed or instinctual goal. This is true and valid for the numinous as well as phenomenological realms.

The cosmic fertility aspect of this rune points to the Vanic god Freyr, who is invoked *til árs ok fridhar* (for good season [harvest] and peace).

The Old Norse name *ár* provides us with the popular association of this rune with the eagle (ON *ari*) as a symbol of the swift flight of the archetypal sun.

Key words:

Cyclical development
Solar year cycle (12)
Reward
Fruition
Eagle

Galdr:

jera jera jera
jjjjeeeerrrraaaa
jjjjjjjjj
ju ja ji je jo
(jur jar jir jer jor)
jjjjeeeerrrraaaa

.....

Stadha:

Stand upright with right arm bent so that the thumb of the right hand touches the crown of the head. The left arm is bent at the same angle with the fingertips of the left hand touching the left hip bone.



Magical workings:

1. Fertility, creativity.
2. Peace, harmony.
3. Enlightenment.
4. Realization of the cyclical nature of the multiverse.
5. Realization of the mystery of the omnipresent circumference.
6. Bringing other concepts into material manifestation.

13

Names: GMC *eihwaz* or *iwaz*: yew tree

GO *eihwas*: yew tree

OE *éoh*: yew tree, or *eow*: mountain ash

ON **ihwar*: yew (in runic inscriptions only)

It is not in the younger row in this form, but the Norse Futhark has *ýr*: yew; bow of yew wood in the form : ᚢ :. See Z-rune.



Alternate forms: | ᚢ ᚦ *

Phonetic value: uncertain—somewhere between *e* and *i*. This rune stave is essentially a magical sign that occurs infrequently in the writing of words.

Esoteric interpretation of name: yew as the tree of life and death—the world-tree, Yggdrasill.

Ideographic interpretation: the vertical column of the multiversal tree.

COMMENTARY

Eihwaz is the vertical axis of the world that defines the central column of Yggdrasill, the cosmic tree. The world-tree of the ancient Norse was in most cases actually symbolized by a yew tree, not an ash as often supposed. This idea is supported by the old texts, which always refer to its “evergreen” quality and its needles—the yew is a conifer. An alternate name for the yew in Old Norse is also *barraskr* (needle ash). The word Yggdrasill means either “Yggr’s (Ódhinn’s) steed,” or “yew-column.” The former meaning is a direct reference to the shamanistic ritual in the “Hávamál.” The gallows often are poetically described as the “horse of the hanged” in Old Norse. This is the rite by which the *erilaz* fares to Hel (realm of the dead, or underworld) and thence to all Nine Worlds to gain their wisdom. This is accomplished along the vertical dimension of the multiverse. The : ᚢ : defines this “numinous axis” that pierces through and connects the three realms

of heaven, earth, and the underworld. A similar, but distinct function is performed by the T-rune. There the emphasis is on *separation*; here, on *communication*.

This rune contains the mystery of life and death, and mystically unifies them in its essence. The yew (*Taxus baccata*) contains an alkaloid toxin that affects the central nervous system. Prepared properly, this is a powerful hallucinogen. A certain professor of medicine named Kukowka, at the University of Greiz in East Germany, discovered that on warm days the yew emits a gaseous toxin that lingers in the shade of the tree and may cause hallucinations for an individual under its branches. The importance of this discovery in the study of the shamanistic character of the Yggdrasill initiation should not be lost. Besides its association with death, the yew tree is also a symbol of eternal life and endurance. This is because of its "evergreen" nature and because it is an extremely long-lived (up to two thousand years) and hardy tree with exceptionally hard wood. The yew is often found in the old church graveyards of Europe—former sites of Ásatrú temples.

Eihwaz is a life-giving force and the mode by which that force is sustained.

In the younger row this rune is represented by : 𐌿 : (ON *ýr*) sometimes meaning "bow made of yew wood." This is because bows often were fashioned from the hard resilient yew wood, and because of the connection of the "Bow God," Ullr, with the mystery of the yew. Ullr is the archaic death god who rules the season of Yule.

The yew is also a powerful stave of protection and banishing. (See also the form : ƿ : and its connections in this regard.) Even today in certain parts of Germany the magical saying: "*Vor den Eiben kann kein Zauber bleiben* (before the yews, no (evil) magic can remain) may be heard. We also have a preserved runic talisman that is an example of "yew magic." This is found on the stave of Britsum, carved in yew wood sometime between 500 and 650 C.E. In the Frisian dialect, its inscription is interpreted as "Always carry this yew! Strength is contained in it!"

Key words:

Vertical cosmic axis
Numinous initiation
Life/death
Endurance
Protection

Galdr:

eihwaz eihwaz eihwaz
(iwaz iwaz iwaz)
e e e e e e e e
(a neutral, closed vowel sound)
iwu iwa iwi iwe iwo
iwo iwe iwi iwa iwu
e e e e e e e e

Stadha:

Stand upright and stretch both arms down at a 50° angle, while lifting the left (or right) leg back at an equal angle.



Magical workings:

1. Initiation into the wisdom of the World-Tree.
2. Realization of the death/life mystery and liberation from the fear of death.
3. Development of spiritual endurance and hard will.
4. Spiritual creativity and vision.
5. Protection from detrimental forces.
6. General increase in personal power.
7. Communication between levels of reality—the worlds of Yggdrasill.
8. Memories of former existences in the ancestral stream.

14

Names: GMC *perthro*: device for casting lots

GO *pairthra*: dice cup

OE *peordh*: chess man(?)

ON (not in Norse row, functions absorbed by : ƿ : , : þ : , and : ʀ :)

Alternate forms: 𐌱 𐌿

Phonetic value: *p*

Esoteric interpretation of name: divination as an indicator of *φrlög*, the “primal laws.”

Ideographic interpretation: dice cup—as a device used for casting lots.



COMMENTARY

Perthro is a cultic symbol for the force of *φrlög* functioning throughout the multiverse and the way in which men and gods may investigate

its workings. *ǫrlög* is most often translated by the word “fate,” but this is much too simplistic and unfortunately loaded with connotations of “predestination” and “predetermination” of the type found in Christian dogma. This sense is totally lacking in the Norse term. *ǫrlög* literally means “primal layers”; that is, the layers (ON *lög*: “laws”) of past or former action indicated by the prefix *ǫr*, which signifies the most primal or basic form of something in time or space. These self-determined layers of past action are the laws by which gods and men are governed. These are not the immutable laws of nature but rather the immutable laws by which the laws of wights are formed by past action and by precedent. This cosmic principle is at the root of Germanic common law. Clearly, it is a concept much akin to that expressed by the Sanskrit *karma* and is contrary to the Judeo-Christian predestination.

The P-rune contains the mystery of the Nornic laws. The Nornir are the medium through which action is received and transmuted into a projectable but essentially unaltered form and returned to the sphere from which that action was received. This is the rune of time, and this idea is also expressed by the Nornir. Their names are Urdhr, Verdhandi, and Skuld (Urdhr, “that which has become”; Verdhandi, “that which is becoming”; Skuld, “that which should become”—a non-past/present concept). Nornic force defines an aspect of the laws of cause and effect in the multiverse, and as such, an understanding of this force is indispensable in the working of runecraft.

The mystery of divination, and of synchronicity, is central to the P-rune. By the art of divination the vitki is able to investigate personal or transpersonal *ǫrlög* and become aware of the Skuld-force, as well as the influences of Urdhr and Verdhandi.

Perthro is the great pattern of cosmic becoming, which should be understood according to the principles outlined above. It represents the paradigm along which resistance (: 𐀓 :) between forces is organically governed and balanced.

The P-rune is perceived as a constant change—that always remains the same.

Key words:

ǫrlög
Time
Urdhr—Verdhandi—Skuld
Cause and effect
Evolution—change

Galdr:

perthro perthro perthro
pu pa pi pe po
purdh pardh pirdh perdh pordh
po pe pi pa pu
peeeerrrrththththrrroooo

Stadha:

Sit on ground with back straight. Bring knees up with feet flat on the ground. Rest elbows on knees with forearms slanted forward. Face west.



Magical workings:

1. Perception of *þrlög*.
2. Divination.
3. Placing runic forces in the stream of Nornic law.
4. To evolve ideas or events as a magical act.

15

Names: GMC *elhaz* or *algiz*: elk, protection
 GO *algis*: swan (?)
 OE *eolh*: elk
 ON **ihwar*: (in runic inscriptions only) yew, yew bow



Alternate forms: Ψ $\times$ A

Phonetic value: a final grammatical *z*, which eventually developed into the final *r* of Old Norse.

Esoteric interpretation of name: protective force, *valkyrjur*.

Ideographic interpretation: the horns of the elk, the branches (and roots) of the tree, a swan in flight, or a splayed hand.

COMMENTARY

This rune is historically perhaps the most complex of all from a symbological perspective. A unified ideological complex does rise to the surface once its secrets are penetrated.

The Proto-Germanic form *algiz* means “protection,” and its stave form is perhaps derived from the basic sign of defense and protection: the splayed hand. The concept of the *valkyrjur* also has been connected to this stave through the interpretation of the name as “swan.” The *valkyrjur* are protective, life-giving beings who often fly by means of magical cloaks made of swan feathers. These beings are protectors, power givers, and a mode by which Óðinn communicates with his chosen heroes.

The sign : ʏ : is often found carved into spears for protection and victory.

Elhaz, meaning “elk,” refers to the four cosmic harts that constantly bite at the needles of the world-tree. The yew again comes into the symbol complex of this rune with the Old Norse word *i(h)war*, which occurs only in runic inscriptions. This term means either “yew tree” or “yew bow” and is later rendered by the word *ýr* and the stave form : ʏ :: This form is an alternate of the usual : ʏ : and in fact they are probably derived from a primal form : ʏ : found in the Futhark of Charnay. This oldest form displays the tree symbolism quite graphically.

The Gothic word *alhs* (sanctuary) has been related to this rune as well. This is a protected grove or enclosure dedicated to the gods. The Z-rune contains an aspect of the protective power of the divine twins. *Alcis*, the name of the twins reported by Tacitus in the *Germania*, may indeed be related to the rune name. Ideographically, the divine twins were sometimes represented as being joined at the head, rather like the primal form of the rune (see Figure 2.3).

In their aggressive, warlike aspect, the twins are visualized as harts, while in other aspects they are represented as horses (see E-rune).

Elhaz is the power of human life and “spirit” striving toward the world of the AEsir.

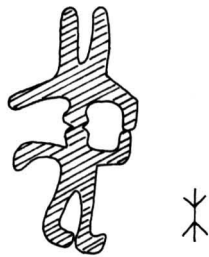


Figure 2.3. Divine twins, from the rock carving of Ryland/Tanum.

It is the rune of the connection between gods and humanity, the force that draws the consciousness of man toward the realm of the gods. The Z-rune is the three-colored bridge of shimmering light, Bifröst, the "Rainbow Bridge" of Norse mythology. This bridge connects Ásgardhr, Midhgardhr, and Hel. It is another mode for the consciousness to traverse the worlds. It is the curved path of the branches and roots rather than the straight path of the trunk (: √ :), a symbol of the magical power of the *hamingja*. The Z-rune is the force used by Heimdallr in his aspect as guardian of Ásgardhr. *Elhaz* is a rune of consciousness and awareness (a *hugrún*). It is over Bifröst that the rime- and fire-giants destroy the worlds of men and gods. All this is best understood through a synthesis of the diverse mysteries presented above.

The *stödhur* of the Z-rune are the traditional postures in which the Germanic peoples communicate with the gods (see the section of *Stadhagaldr*). Also, this shape was later employed as the M-rune in the Younger Futhark.

Key words:

Protection—enclosure
Life
Bifröst
Path of the branches and roots
Connection between gods and men

Galdr:

elhaz elhaz elhaz
z z z z z z z z z
(a deep whirring, whistling sound)
uz az iz ez oz
oz ez iz az uz
zzzzzzzzzz
(mmmmmmmmmm)

Stödhur:

I. Stand upright with the arms stretched out upwards and to the sides.

II. Keep arm position the same as above, but kneel, sitting on the heels. Keep torso vertical with the head slightly tilted back.

III. Same arm position with the right knee on the ground and the left foot out in front with the thigh parallel to the ground.



Magical workings:

1. Protection, defense.
2. Mystical and religious communication with nonhuman sentient beings.
3. Communication with other worlds, especially Ásgardhr and the cosmic wells of Urdhr, Mimir, and Hvergelmir.
4. Strengthening of *hamingja* (magical power and “luck”) and life force (see M-rune for more practical applications of the shape).

16Names: GMC *sowilo*: sunGO *saugil*: sunOE *sigil*: sunON *sól*: sun

Alternate forms: ᚱ ᚷ ᚲ ᚲ ᚲ ᚲ

Phonetic value: *s*

Esoteric interpretation of name: the holy solar wheel.

Ideographic interpretation: one part ᚲ of the dynamic solar wheel ᚷ, which developed with the form ⊕; or the thunderbolt.

**COMMENTARY**

The S-rune is the archetypal sun and the light of that sun, symbolically expressed as the solar wheel. The concept of the turning wheel (ON *hvel*) is central to the understanding of the rune. This is represented as the wheels of the solar wagon, : ƿ : as well as the disk which is borne by that cosmic vehicular force. This symbol complex is the center of the ancient hyperborean sun cult, which was at its peak in the Bronze Age. The sun was known by two special names in the North. These are reflected in Old Norse *sól* and the cult word *sunna* (both feminine). In the “Alvíssmal” (stanza 16) of the *Elder Edda* we read:

It is called Sól among men
and Sunna among the Gods.

Sól represents the phenomenon, while *sunna* is the noumenon, the spiritual power residing in the concept. The mystery of the sun is essentially a feminine one—the sun and solar power were considered feminine attributes by the ancient Germanic peoples.

Sowilo is the magical will that is active throughout the multiverse. Within the individual, this will is expressed through the “spiritual wheels,” the *hvel*. This word is an exact cognate to the Sanskrit *čakra*. In this aspect it is a counterforce to the power of cosmic ice. The S-rune often has been connected to the power of the lightning bolt, and thus to the concepts embodied in *thurisaz*.

Sowilo is the eminent spiritual force that guides the *vitki* through the paths of Yggdrasill. It is an aspect of the goal, and also the active, willed path toward that goal. The S-rune may serve as a dynamic connection between heaven and earth (Ásgardhr and Midhgardhr). *Sowilo* is the rune of the Germanic code of honor, a powerful path to ecstatic experience.

In later times this rune became known as the “victory rune.” Indeed, it is a potent, willed force. This can bring great success and victory to an individual when properly applied. But the true *sigrún* (victory rune) of the ancients was the T-rune.

Key words:

Solar wheel
Magical will
Guide
Goal and path
Success
Honor

Galdr:

sowilo sowilo sowilo
ssssssssss
sssssooollll
su sa si se so
(sul sal sil sel sol)
us as is es os
so se si sa su
ssssssssss

Stödhur:

I. Squat so that the calves and thighs are pressed together along their entire length, with the buttocks resting on the heels. Keep the torso vertical, with the arms along the sides of the thighs.



II. Standing with the body in the form of the S-rune, angle the arms along the sides of the body while the joints of the hips and knees form the $\mathcal{L}$ rune.

These *stöðhur* are reflected by an Old Norse term *knésól* (knee-sun) which describes the S-rune.

.....

Magical workings:

1. Strengthening of the psychic centers, *hvel*.
2. Increase in spiritual will.
3. Guidance through the pathways, "enlightenment."
4. Victory and success through individual will.

17

Names: GMC *tiwaz*: the god Týr
 GO *teiwaz*: the god Týr
 OE *tir*: the god Týr (OE *Tiw*),
 glory
 ON Týr: the god Týr

Alternate forms: 1 7

Phonetic value: *t*

Esoteric interpretation of name: the sky god.

Ideographic interpretation: the vault of the heavens ^ held up by the universal column |, and sometimes the spear point.



COMMENTARY

The T-rune embodies the force ruled by the god Ása-Týr. Týr is the Norse god of law and justice, who governs proceedings at the *thing* (the Germanic general assembly). The Týr force is one of passive regulation. In northern mythology, it is this god who comes closest to a transcendental quality. These characteristics are exemplified by the major Týr myth in which the god sacrifices his hand ("active abilities") between the jaws of the Fenris wolf in order to save his

fellow Æsir from destruction. Thus *tiwaz* is the rune of self-sacrifice and of kings and great leaders of the people.

The word *tiwaz*, *týr* in Old Norse, is the exact cognate to Sanskrit *dayus*, Greek Zeus, and Latin *Ju-piter*. A threefold mystery is contained in *tiwaz*: (1) justice, (2) war, and (3) world-column. Certain aspects of all three concepts are intimately related in the runic cosmology. *Tiwaz* is principally the force of divine order in the multiverse, and especially among mankind. But Týr is also important as a "war god." This is because of the special judicial and spiritual qualities that were imparted to conflict by the ancient Northmen. An Old Norse word sums up this aspect quite well: *vápnadómr* ("judgment by arms: war). Combat was seen as a struggle between numinous forces in conjunction with physical ones. Both of these are considered to be extensions of the same ultimate source. The man, or army, with the most numinous power (which is developed by right and honorable past action) will be favored by *þrlog* to win the struggle. Týr rules over the administration of this form of justice, so he is invoked for victory and is therefore an important war god. The aspect of the world-column expressed by the T-rune is that of the separator of heaven and earth. This separation creates a phenomenological quality, and is therefore necessary to multiversal manifestation as we know it. This column maintains world order, and protects humanity and the gods from the destruction that would come should the heavens (energy) and earth (matter) collapse into one another.

Tiwaz is represented by the Irminsul of the Saxons (Figure 2.4). This world-column is the *axis mundi* and has its heavenly termination in the pole star.

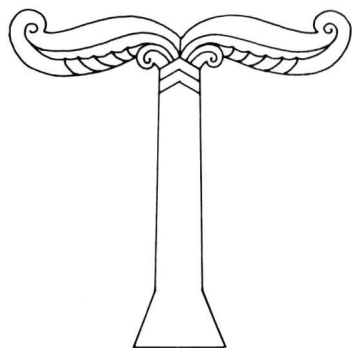


Figure 2.4. The Irminsul of the Saxons.

The T-rune is the mystery of spiritual discipline and faith according to divine law. It is the religious instinct in the individual and society.

Tiwaz facilitates social integration and regulation according to the spiritual code of the AEsir.

Key words:

Justice
World order
Victory (according to law)
Self-sacrifice
Spiritual discipline

Galdr:

tiwaz tiwaz tiwaz
tiiiirrrrr
tu ta ti te to
tur tar tir ter tor
ot et it at ut
(Týr Týr)
Tiiiirrrrr

Stödhur:

Stand straight, arms slanted down and away from the body in the form of the stave. Palms face the ground, although you may also experiment with the palms up.



This *stadha* was developed as a bind rune of :ᚦ: and : ↑ :, and is popularly known as the Sig-Týr rune. It embodies the combined forces of these two powerful symbols. The *galdr* "Sig-Týr Sig-Týr Sig-Týr" should be used when invoking its force.



Magical workings:

1. Obtaining just victory and success.
2. Building spiritual will.
3. Develops the power of *positive* self-sacrifice.
4. Develops the "force of faith" in magic and religion.

18

Names: GMC *berkano*: birch goddess
 GO *baírkan*: birch twig
 OE *beorc*: birch tree
 ON *bjarkan*: runic birch goddess
 (from ON *björk*: birch)



Alternate forms: ᚷ ᚢ ᚷ ᚷ

Phonetic value: *b*

Esoteric interpretation of name: the numen of the birch as earth mother.

Ideographic interpretation: breasts of the earth mother △△.

COMMENTARY

The B-rune contains the complex mystery of the great mother. In its cosmological aspect it is the mother of all manifestation and embodies the mysteries of cosmic and human birth and rebirth.

Berkano rules over the four pivotal human "rites of passage," which take place at the crucial times of birth, adolescence, marriage, and death. This birch goddess also displays the darker side of the "Terrible Mother," ruling over death. In Norse mythology she is represented by Hel. In the *Germania*, chapter 40, Tacitus reports on the goddess Nerthus as the earth mother. In this cult, the goddess is attended by a priest and she is drawn throughout the territory in her chariot, spreading her blessings of peace and fertility. When the procession is at an end, Nerthus receives human sacrifice in order to replenish her spent power.

The B-rune is the container of all becoming/being. It is the unity of the birth-life-death-rebirth cycle through the "mystery of the moment." This is the "unit of evolution," that moment of "being" (a single complete cycle of arising-being/becoming-passing-away to new arising) from which "becoming" is built. The phenomenon of chance in nature is described by this rune, because each moment each of these units of existence has its own uniqueness, although they are all held together by a universal pattern.

Berkano is the passive receptor and the conserving protective force. It conceals and protects. The B-rune rules over all protective or concealing enclosures such as caves, lodges, or the initiatory "earth houses" (ON *jardhhús*).

Key words:

Earth mother
Birth
Birth-life-death cycle
Containment
Moment

Galdr:

berkano berkano berkano
bu ba bi be bo
b e e e e r r r r r
(burk bark birk berk bork)
ob eb ib ab ub
b e e e e r r r r r

.....

Stadha:

Stand erect with the left arm bent at the elbow, the palm resting on the hip. The left leg is bent at the knee with the heels touching. The left foot is set at a 90° angle to the right foot. The elbow and knee form the angles of the B-rune.



.....

Magical workings:

1. Rebirth in the spirit.
2. Strengthens the power of secrecy.
3. Works of concealment and protection.
4. To contain and hold other powers together.
5. Realization of the oneness of the moment as the mother of all things.
6. Bringing ideas to fruition in the creative process.

19

Names: GMC *ehwaz*: horse, or *ehwo*: the
two horses

GO *aſhws*: stallion

OE *eh*: war horse

ON *íor*: horse (used only in cultic
contexts, and not found in the
Younger Futhark)



Alternate forms:  

Phonetic value: *e*

Esoteric interpretation of name: the twin gods or heroes in
equine aspect.

Ideographic interpretation: two upright poles bound together
to symbolize the divine twins (the Bronze Age symbol  represented these divinities); also the sign of two horses
facing one another.

COMMENTARY

Ehwo represents the power of the twin gods. This power construct is a reflection of a dual form of Germanic kingship. These leaders often were represented mythically as horses. Here we think of Hengist (stallion) and Horsa (horse), the Saxon conquerors of Britain. Also, the name of the twin gods of the Veda, the *Aśvinau*, literally means “the *two* horses.” The harmonious relationship between the two forces represented in the dual construct is emphasized, rather than the defensive and outwardly directed power expressed in the Z-rune. All this points to the close relationship between man and horse felt by the Indo-Europeans in general and the Germanic peoples in particular. The horse is a source of numinous knowledge, and horses often were consulted by the ancient Germanic priests in divinatory rites.

The *ehwaz* is a spiritual quality closely connected to mankind (*mannaz*). In Old Norse it is said: *marr er manns fylgja* (the horse is a man’s fetch). The bind rune of *ᛗ* and *ᛞ* is *ᛞᛗ* (*em*), which means “I am.”

The E-rune facilitates the journey between the worlds of *Yggdrasill*—the *vitki* may literally ride its power through the realms of reality. *Ehwaz* is the rune of *Sleipnir*, *Ódhinn*’s eight-legged steed.

Many runic talismans portray a man riding a horse as a symbol form for integrated magical protection, under the rulership of Ódhinn. This is the otherworldly aspect of *ehwaz*, but the horse also is connected with fertility magic, and thus to Freyr, the god of fertility, peace, and sensuality.

This is a rune of trust and loyalty. The spiritual relationship that a horseman develops for his horse is a good illustration of the might of this rune. There is much power to be gained in this secret.

Ehwaz is the combination of *two* sympathetic, yet dually arrayed forces or entities (such as man/horse, horse/chariot, man/*fylgja*, body/soul) that work harmoniously together toward one goal (see the TH-rune for the contrasting concept).

The E-rune is the symbol of the ideal man-woman relationship and thus is the mystery of lawful marriage.

Key words:

Harmonious duality
Vehicle of otherworldly
journeys
Fertility
Trust, loyalty
Legal marriage

Galdr:

ehwo ehwo ehwo
eeeehwooooo
ehwu ehwa ehwi ehwe ehwo
ehwo ehwe ehwi ehwa ehwu
eeeehwooooo
(Also experiment with the
singular form *ehwaz*)

Stödhur:

1. Stand straight with both arms slanted, the left pointed upward and the right downward to form the alternate form of the E-rune: ƿ̅.
2. Also experiment with the E-rune *bind-stadha*, in which two vitkar, usually male and female, stand facing one another, each in the L-rune position, thus forming the E-rune: ƿ̅ ƿ̅.



Magical workings:

1. Facilitation of "soul travel" throughout the worlds and projection of the "soul" in Midhgardhr.
2. Realization of fundamental unity of the psychosomatic complex.
3. Imparts trust and loyalty.
4. A source of prophetic wisdom.
5. Projection of magical power.
6. Facilitates swiftness in every regard.

20

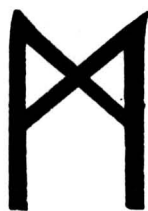
Names: GMC *mannaz*: human
 GO *manna*: man, human
 OE *mann*: man, human
 ON *madhr*: a man, human being

Alternate forms: ᚱ ᚦ ᚦ ᚦ ᚦ

Phonetic value: *m*

Esoteric interpretation of name: the divine ancestor and sky father.

Ideographic interpretation: marriage X between heaven and earth.



COMMENTARY

Mannaz is the mystery of the divine (archetypal) structure in every individual and in mankind in general. This structure is imparted by the god Heimdallr as the progenitor of mankind. This is described in the "Rígsthula" of the *Elder Edda*. In this poem it is told how Rígr (Heimdallr) engendered the archetypal members of the three social functions in the world of men—the Provider, the Warrior, and the Priest-King—which reflect the three levels of the divine structure. Heimdallr is indeed Óðinn in one of his many guises, that of the All-Father (Alfadir).

The M-rune is the symbol of Heimdallr as the genetic link between the gods and men, and as the guardian of Bifröst.

This is the rune that describes the Germanic peoples as being descended from their divine order and defines mankind as the progeny of the gods. It is the mystery of humanity and represents the runic structure in the soul of man.

Mannaz is the power of human intelligence, rationality, memory, and tradition.

It is the stave of the "perfected man"—the complete human being—an initiate in one of the many cults of the Elder Faith. *Mannaz* is an androgynous archetypal being, and therefore the mystery is one

that embodies the power of the androgyne in the psychological sphere of humanity.

The M-rune stands for the institution of blood brotherhood.

Key words:

Divine structure
Divine link
Intelligence
Androgyne
Initiate

Galdr:

mannaz mannaz mannaz
mmmmmaaaaaannnnn
mu ma mi me mo
mun man min men mon
um am im em om
mon men min man mun
mmmmmaaaaaannnnn
mmmmmmmmmm

Stödhur:

Stand erect with elbows lifted straight up and forearms crossed in front of the face or behind the head.

Use the elder Z-rune *stadha*, which is used as the younger M-stave ƿ *madhr*.

In both cases the *stadha* will increase the power of the head (*hvel*).



Magical workings:

1. Realization of the divine structure in mankind.
2. Increase in intelligence, memory, and mental powers generally.
3. Balancing the "poles of personality."
4. Unlocking the *hugauga*, the "mind's eye."

21

Names: GMC *laguz*: a body of water (or
laukaz: leek)
 GO *lagus*: water
 OE *lagu*: sea, water
 ON *lögr*: sea, water (or *laukr*: leek)



Alternate forms: 𐌋 𐌌

Phonetic value: *l*

Esoteric interpretation of names: life energy and organic growth.

Ideographic interpretation: a wave, or the quick growing green portion of the leek.

COMMENTARY

Laguz is the basic life energy in the multiverse and the secret source of all organic life. *Laguz* is the law (ON *lög*) of life, throughout all the multiverse as well as in Midhgardhr. These are the layers (laws) of past cosmic and human action that govern the future development of life forms.

The L-rune represents the primal waters in Niflheimr that contain the latent, amorphous potential of life, which must be solidified as ice and energized by the fire of Muspellsheimr before the potential can be actualized in manifested pattern.

This is a potent rune of initiation—especially the initiation into life. In heathen times a newborn child was sprinkled with water and given its name, after it had shown itself worthy of life. This reintegrated the child into the life force of its clan. The mystery of *vatni ausa* (the ritual of sprinkling with water) predates Christian influence and is a feature of the ancient Nordic doctrine of rebirth—*aptrburdhr*. The functions of the U- and L-runes are closely inter-related on different levels.

Laguz also includes the watery rite of passage at the end of life—the crossing of the primeval waters to the realm of the dead. The

myths of Óðhinn as the ferryman of the souls are important in this regard. The ship burials of the Vikings and the symbolic water crossing indicated by them also are illustrative of this belief.

The form *laukaz* also means "leek," which is expressed in the Old Norse rune name *laukr*. This is a symbol of organic growth, phallic power (virtue), and fertility in the physical as well as spiritual realms. The L-rune rules over the lore of herbal magic, known in Old Norse as *lyf* and in Old English as *lac-nunga*. The *ítrlaukr* (shining leek) was often given to a young man once he had proved himself as a warrior.

Key words:

Life
Primal water
Passage to and from life
Growth
Vital power

Galdr:

laguz laguz laguz
lllllllll
lu la li le lo
(lug lag lig leg log)
ul al il el ol
lo le li la lu
lllllllll
lllllllll

Stadha:

Stand erect with both arms stretched straight out in front of the chest, slanted downward. The palms point to the ground. Practice also with palms pointed up.



Magical workings:

1. Guidance through difficult initiatory tests.
2. Increase in vitality and life force.
3. Gathering of amorphous magical power for formation and structuring by the will.
4. Increase in "magnetism."
5. Development of "second sight."

22



Names: GMC *ingwaz*: the god Ing
 GO *enguz* or *iggws*: the god Ing, a
 man
 OE *Ing*: the god or hero Ing
 ON *Ing* or *Yngvi*: the god Ing (later
 a name of Freyr)

Alternate forms: ✘ † ○ □

Phonetic value: *ng* as in "long"

Esoteric interpretation of name: the earth god

Ideographic interpretation: † —the male genitalia; ◇ —the
 castrated male.

COMMENTARY

Ingwaz is considered to be the name of an old Germanic earth god, who works in tandem with the earth mother, Nerthus. Their cult was most developed in ancient times in the North Sea regions. The Old English Rune Poem tells us

Ing was at first
 among the East-Danes
 seen by men,
 until he went eastward
 over the wave,
 his wain rolled after him:
 thus the Heardings
 named the hero.

The wagon or chariot mentioned is the same used in the Nerthus cult. *Ingwaz* represents the male consort of the earth mother, and the priest who attends her. So strong was this cult among the peoples of the North Sea that they were often referred to as *Ingvaeones* (those of Ing).

The Vanic god Freyr also was known as *Yngvi*, and he too took part in fertility rites in which he rode in a wagon in ritual processions. Freyr seems generally to have usurped the role and the name of Ing in the North.

In the Ing-Nerthus cult the female element consumes the male to replenish her powers after spending them giving fertility to the

land and people. Here there are strong overtones of a Cybele-Attis type of cult. The myth of Freyr giving up his sword to gain Gerdhr or the Óðhinic name Gelding (castrated horse), may be illustrative here. The male element represents the self-replenishing "cosmic food" of potential energy, which is held through winter by the goddess to be suddenly and violently released again in spring during the orgiastic processional ritual.

The NG-rune is a storehouse of potential energy that must undergo a gestation period in order to gain in strength. This is a principle that works on all levels of the multiverse, and it is a mighty rune of magic, for all power must undergo such a protected gestation period before it may be manifested in its most potent form.

One of the great secrets of Nordic sex magic is embodied in this rune.

Key words:

Potential energy
Gestation

Galdr:

ingwaz ingwaz ingwaz
iiiiinnnnnggggg
ung ang ing eng ong
ong eng ing ang ung
iiiiinnnnnggggg

Stödhur:

1. Stand straight with fingertips touching well overhead and elbows angled in the form of the stave.



2. Stand erect with fingertips touching just above the genitals with elbows forming the angles of the NG-rune.



Magical workings:

1. Storage and transformation of power for ritual use.
2. Fertility rites.
3. Passive meditation and centering of energy and thought.
4. Sudden release of energy.

23

Names: GMC *dagaz*: day
 GO *dags*: day
 OE *dæg*: day
 ON *dagr*: day (not in younger row)



Alternate forms: 

Phonetic values: *d* and voiced *th* as in "then."

Esoteric interpretation of name: the light of day.

Ideographic interpretation: the balance between night and day.

COMMENTARY

Dagaz is the light of day, perceived at the moments of sunrise and sunset, dawn and twilight. It is the rune of total awakening. The mystery of this rune is expressed in the invocatory verses spoken by Sigrdrífa when she is awakened from a magical slumber by the hero Sigurdhr ("the warder of victory"):

Hail Day!
 Hail to Day's sons!
 Hail Night and her daughter!
 Look upon us twain
 with loving eyes
 and give those sitting here speed!

Hail the Gods!
 Hail the Goddesses!
 Hail the much needed earth!
 Sayings and sage wit
 give to us, the storied ones,
 and healing hands in this life!

(*Poetic Edda* "Sigurdifumal" stanzas 2-3)

The D-rune represents the ritual fire of the hearth and the mystic light perceived by the vitki in magical operations.

Dagaz is the synthesis of the powers of day and night through the concepts of dawn and twilight. This is expressed by the heavenly phenomena of the morning and evening stars—as symbols of the divine twins.

This is the rune of polarity and of the “Ódhinic paradox,” which is the central mystery of the Ódhinic cult. It is embodied in the paradoxical nature of the god Ódhinn himself and is best explained in terms of the “mystical moment.” This is the moment that is sought out and that is found in the vortex of polarized concepts. These concepts are syncretized through a secret “alchemy” in which two extremes become one. *Dagaz* is that time/place in which darkness and light, pleasure and pain, life and death, body and soul, matter and energy are synthesized into a common concept that goes beyond their *perceived* opposition. In *dagaz*, language fails.

Key words:

Light
Polarity
Syncretization
“Ódhinic paradox”

Galdr:

dagaz dagaz dagaz
dhhdhdhdhdhdhdhdhdh
daaaaagaaaazzzz
du da di de do
dh dh dh dh dh
odh edh idh adh udh
od ed id ad ud
daaaaagaaaazzzz

Stadha:

Stand straight and cross arms in front of the chest in a D-rune form, with the fingertips touching the shoulders.



Magical workings:

1. Attaining mystical moment through penetration of the secret of the Ódhinic paradox.
2. Reception of mystical inspiration—the gift of Ódhinn.

24

Names: GMC *othala*: ancestral property
 GO *othal*: property
 OE *éthel*: homeland, property
 ON *ódhal*: nature, inborn quality,
 property (not in younger row)



Alternate forms: ⚔ ℓ Ȧ

Phonetic value: *o*

Esoteric interpretation of name: immobile hereditary property.

Ideographic interpretation: enclosed estate dynamically interacting with the environment.

COMMENTARY

The mystery of *othala* is symbolized by the stronghold enclosure of the clan, which defines its holy boundary and serves to defend it against the unholy intruders. It is the essence of the cosmic concept of Midhgardhr—the enclosure in the middle.

The O-rune also is a sign of inborn qualities that are the result of descent from a certain clan or tribe. This is essentially spiritual in origin and is ultimately derived from the divine ancestry plus past action of the ancestors. *Othala* is the mystery of the *fylgja* as a spiritual source of magical power, which results from the virtuous deeds of past generations as runic imprints into the “genetic codes” of the descendants—a powerful rune of Ódhinn. The stave form :⚔: serves as a monogram of Ódhinn.

It is a symbol of that which is inherited through the generations by the whole clan in both the material and spiritual realms. It is as immovable as the land and cannot be transferred out of the clan/tribe. However, through the institution of marriage those outside the clan have access to its power through integration with it.

Othala is the wise and just management of the land by the noble ones: those possessed of the spiritual power of this rune in accordance with clanic tradition and law.

This is the rune of material prosperity and well-being. It works together with the complementary concept of mobile property—power contained in the F-rune to develop and maintain this important quality in the multiverse. *Othala* is the rune that provides human liberty in a secure and lawful society, integrated with itself and with its environment. It is preserved clanic and tribal law on a spiritual level. In Ásatrú this rune is expressed by the kindred.

Key words:

Sacred enclosure
Inherited power
Preserved freedom
Prosperity

Galdr:

othala othala othala
oooooooooooo
ooooo
othul othal othil othel othol
othol othel othil othal othul
ooooo

Stödhur:

I. Stand with legs spread wide, as in the G-rune *stadha*, and arms in the second NG-rune *stadha*, with fingertips touching just above the genitals. This is effective in operations to bring the will of the vitki into manifestation.

II. Again stand with legs spread, but with the arms in the first NG-rune *stadha*, with fingertips touching well overhead. This *stadha* is most effective in works of inspirational intent.

**Magical workings:**

1. Maintaining order among fellows.
2. Concentration on common interests in home and family.
3. Shift from ego-centricity to clano-centricity.
4. Collection of numinous power and knowledge from past generations.
5. Acquisition of wealth and prosperity.

